

Equivalence Partitioning

A design technique that divides inputs or conditions into classes expected to behave equivalently.

Idea

Instead of testing every value, group valid and invalid values expected to be handled the same way.

Example

For accepted age 18–65: classes can be <18, 18–65 and >65.

Benefit

Reduces combinations while keeping representative coverage.

Caution

Classes must reflect real rules; poor partitions can hide meaningful differences.

When to use it

Use this knowledge when product risk, architecture or the delivery stage requires this type of validation. Confirm the goal, environment, required data and expected evidence before starting.

How QA applies it

Start from the behavior or risk to validate, prepare data and environment, execute the technique or tool reproducibly and capture evidence that helps the team understand the result.

QA tip

After defining partitions, combine them with boundary values for stronger coverage.